ENGLISH GRAMMAR IN USE · UNITS 1–17

RESPAWN ANSWER KEY

HOW TO CHECK

Bold = the expected answer; grey after a slash = also correct. Contractions and full forms are equally fine (*'ve* = *have*). The tags (U7) tell you which unit an item tests: for every mistake, colour one square per tag on the *Post-match review* page. Notes in italics explain the tricky ones. *AmE* marks things that are normal in American English but less usual in British English (the book's reference).

1 Snap decisions

U1 U2 U3 U4 U6 U8 U9 U10 U11 U12 U13 U14 U15 U16 U17

Hypercorrection tip: any answer you marked sure *and got wrong goes straight into your Top-5 box in the Post-match review.*

1 **'m cooking** U1

Happening now, at the time of speaking.

2 **lost** U13 U14

Finished time (last week) — and the card isn't lost any more.

3 **Have you got** U17

Possession: Have you got. . . ? / Do you have. . . ? — never continuous.

4 **had been raining** U16

The rain had stopped before I looked: earlier activity + visible result.

5 **always cycle** U3

Every time, neutral. I'm always -ing = too often / irritating.

6 **have you been** U11

From the past until now: How long have you been. . . ?

7 **invented** U13

History, not news (like Who invented the telephone?).

8 **'ve sent** U10

How many → present perfect simple.

9 **is being** U4

Behaviour right now, not his character.

10 **'ve tried** U8

It's the first time + present perfect.

11 **was playing** U6

In the middle of something when something else happened.

12 **since** U12

It's (been) + period + since + past simple.

13 **expands** U2

A general truth.

14 **had grown** U15

The beard came before the moment I saw him.

15 **Have you been running** U9

A recent activity with a result you can see now.

16 **Have you seen** U14

The morning isn't finished yet.

17 **'ve known** U10 U11

Know is a state verb: no continuous form.

18 **had** U17

Past possession = had (normally without got).

19 **are rising** U1

A changing situation (rising, getting, increasing. . .).

20 **'ve been writing** U10

How long + unfinished activity → continuous.

2 Crossword: forms on the fly

U5 U7 U8 U12 U15



ACROSS

1 **spent** U5
3 **frozen** U7
6 **thought** U5 U15
7 **won** U7
9 **forgotten** U8
11 **stolen** U7
13 **understood** U15
14 **met** U5
15 **taught** U5

DOWN

1 **slept** U8 U12
2 **woken** U7
4 **caught** U7
5 **chosen** U7
8 **written** U7 U8
10 **brought** U7
12 **gone** U7

Past simple (finished time, a story): spent, taught, thought, met. Past participle (have/has/had + -ed/-en): all the others. Watch out for won (not winned), woken, frozen, forgotten, understood.

3 Questions in the wild

U2 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

1 How long have you been back in Leuven? U11
2 Have you ever been to the Ardennes? U8
3 What have you been up to since the summer? U9
4 How often do you go to the gym? U2
5 What were you doing when the blackout happened? U6
6 Have you checked the exam timetable yet? U7
7 What time did you go to bed last night? U5 U14
8 Have you got a spare pen? U17
9 Had the lecture already started when you arrived? U15
10 How long have you been learning Dutch? U11 U12

be up to (something) = be doing something. 'What have you been up to?' is one of the most common questions when you meet someone again.

4 Same words, different story

U3 U4 U6 U7 U10 U14 U15 U17

1 **a–i, b–ii** U14

have lived = I still live there; lived = a finished period.

2 **a–ii, b–i** U6 U15

was leaving = she was in the middle of leaving; had left = she had gone before I arrived.

3 **a–i, b–ii** U10

been fixing = the activity (maybe not finished); fixed = the result.

4 **a–ii, b–i** U3

always + continuous = too often, with irritation.

5 **a–ii, b–i** U4

think of (opinion) = simple; thinking about (mental activity now) = continuous.

6 **a–i, b–ii** U4

is = his character; is being = his behaviour right now.

7 **a–ii, b–i** U6

had dinner = after the call; was having dinner = it had already started.

8 **a–i, b–ii** U7

gone = he's there now; been = he went and came back.

9 **a–ii, b–i** U15

had logged off = before the match ended.

10 **a–i, b–ii** U17

having = an event/action happening now; have = possession.

11 **a–ii, b–i** U14

haven't seen = the morning isn't over; didn't see = the morning is finished.

5 One situation, two angles U9 U10 U11 U12 U17

1 I've been revising for the thermodynamics exam since 9 a.m.
I've covered four chapters. U9 U10 U12

2 Wout has been playing ranked all evening.
He's lost six games in a row. U10

3 We've been trying to fix this bug for two hours.
We've found three new bugs. U10 U12

4 My housemate has been cooking since lunchtime.
She's / He's made enough lasagne for ten people. U10

5 I've had this laptop since 2021. (not have been having)
It's crashed three times this week. U10 U11 U17

6 I've been learning Dutch for two years.
I've learnt (learned) about 2,000 words. U10 U12

7 Ines and I have known each other since primary school. (not have been knowing)
She's visited me in Leuven twice. U10 U11

8 I've been training for a half-marathon since September.
I've run over 300 km. U10 U12

Traps: have *(possession) and* know *are state verbs, so they stay simple even with for/since: I've had. . . , we've known. . .*

6 The Monday from hell U5 U6 U15 U16

1 Because his phone had died / his phone's battery had run out (at 6:50). U15

Earlier past → past perfect.

2 He'd been playing Overwatch with his friends (for three hours). U16

3 He was looking for his student card. U6

4 His (bike) chain came off. U5 U6

A short action in the middle of a longer one → past simple.

5 Yes, it had (already) started — seven minutes earlier. U15

6 Because he'd been running (for about twenty minutes). U16

7 They'd been writing for seven minutes. U16

8 *Model:* When Tiago finally walked into the exam hall, the other students had already been writing for seven minutes. He was out of breath because he'd been running since his bike chain came off. He'd overslept: his phone had died during the night, so his alarm hadn't gone off. While the invigilator was finding him a seat, he was still trying to calm down. In the end, the exam went well — not bad for a Monday from hell! U5 U6 U15 U16

7 Continuous allowed? U4 U17

1 ✓ — think of/about = consider, so the continuous is fine. U4

2 ✗ → I don't understand. (understand is a state verb; 'I'm not understanding' is heard informally, but avoid it.) U4

3 ✗ → it needs U4

4 ✓ — for how someone looks or feels now, simple and continuous are both fine. U4
5 ✓ — have = experience/enjoy (an action), not possession. U17
6 ✗ → has / has got (possession) U17
7 ✓ — is being = is behaving (right now). U4
8 ✗ → don't belong U4
9 ✗ → Do you see / Can you see U4
10 ✓ — How are you feeling? = How do you feel? U4
11 ✗ → I usually feel (a general habit) U4
12 ✗ → What do you think of…? (opinion) U4

8 Micro-dialogues

U5 U6 U7 U8 U11 U12 U13 U14 U17

1 **has stolen** / 's stolen U7 U13
2 **did it happen** U13 U14

The news is in the present perfect; the details (when?) go into the past simple.

3 **noticed** U13 U14
4 **'s gone** / has gone U7

He's there now. AmE also: He went to the workshop.

5 **Have you ever tried** U8
6 **had** U13 U14
7 **was** U14
8 **haven't slept** U8 U12
9 **started** U12
10 **have you known** U11
11 **met** U5 U12
12 **spilled** / spilt U5
13 **'ve cut** / have cut U7 U13
14 **did you do** U13
15 **was stripping** U6
16 **slipped** U6
17 **Did you see** U14
18 **didn't have** U17
19 **was working** / worked U6

was working stresses the activity in progress while the match was on; worked is also fine.

20 **went** U12
21 **haven't been** U8 U12
22 **has broken** U8

That's the third time… + present perfect.

23 **'ve brought** / have brought / brought U7 U8

today isn't finished, so the present perfect is the safe choice in BrE; brought is also common.

9 Voice chat: Thursday, 22:47

U1 U3 U4 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U12 U13 U14 U15 U17

1 **'ve just changed** / have just changed U7

AmE also: I just changed.

2 **'re breaking up** / are breaking up U1
3 **'s been spiking** / has been spiking U9
4 **'s downloading** / is downloading / 's been downloading U1

happening now; 's been downloading (all evening) also works.

5 **'s playing** / is playing U1

this game, right now — not in general.

6 **haven't played** U8 U12
7 **lost** U14
8 **'s flanking** / is flanking U1
9 **do you see** / can you see U4
10 **has** / 's got / has got U17
11 **'ve been farming** / have been farming U9
12 **shot** / 's shot / has shot U5 U13

recent news: past simple or present perfect (Unit 13B) — in fast comms the past simple is more common.

13 **'s killed** / has killed U8
14 **'s always doing** / is always doing U3

always + continuous = it happens too often (and it's annoying).

15 **was holding** U6
16 **bombed** U6
17 **got** U15

18 **'d already taken** / had already taken U15
19 **'ve been fighting** / have been fighting U9
20 **still haven't won** U7
21 **think** U4

think = believe/have an opinion → simple.

22 **have you got** / do you have U17
23 **'ve got** / have U17
24 **haven't even started** U7

Phrasebook: 1 c 2 g 3 e 4 f 5 b 6 h 7 a 8 d

10 Group chat: find the ten mistakes

U4 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U10 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

Correct messages: 3, 4, 7 and 13.

1 msg 1: I **finished** the wiring diagram yesterday U14

finished time (yesterday) → past simple

2 msg 2: I**'ve been working** on the PID code since Monday U9 U11

since Monday → present perfect (continuous)

5 msg 5: I **know** a guy. . . U4

know is a state verb

6 msg 6: the left sensor **hasn't worked / hasn't been working** since. . . U11 U12

since + a point in the past → present perfect

8 msg 8: when **did you send** the draft. . . ? U12 U14

When. . . ? asks for a finished time → past simple

9 msg 9: I **was sleeping** U6

in the middle of sleeping when the call came

10 msg 10: It's the first time I**'ve used** an oscilloscope U8

It's the first time + present perfect

11 msg 11: we **had** a meeting with our supervisor last Tuesday U17

past of have (got) = had

12 msg 12: Lien **has written** six pages U10

how much/how many → present perfect simple

14 msg 14: by the time I got to the lab, everyone **had left** U15

they left before I arrived

Vault words: wrap your head around something = *manage to understand something difficult;* chip away at something = *make progress little by little.*

11 The case of the flooded kot

U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U13 U15 U16

A

1 **'ve just arrived** / have just arrived U7

AmE also: I just arrived.

2 **has the water been coming** U9 U11
3 **'s been** / has been U11

be + for weeks, from then until now → present perfect.

4 **'ve told** / have told U7 U8
5 **'ve called** / have called / called U7 U13

new information with a result now (a plumber is coming); called is also possible.

B

a Bram — he was going into the bathroom. U6
b No. She'd had a shower the night before and went straight downstairs. U15
c Downstairs — she had already gone down. U15
d He was (still) sleeping. U6
e Bram. He shaved after his shower, and nobody used the bathroom after him. U5

f *Model:* It wasn't Chloé: she had already gone downstairs when Bram came out of the bathroom, and she never went back up. It wasn't Dries either: when he got up, everyone had already left and the water was already coming under the door. U15

What the tenses tell you: Bram was going into *the bathroom when Ana came out of her room, so Ana used the kitchen. Chloé* had already gone *downstairs when Bram came out, and she never went back up. Dries was asleep until everyone* had left *— and by then the water* was already coming *under the door. So the last person at the sink was Bram, who shaved after his shower. Case closed.*

12 Email to your professor

U7 U8 U9 U10 U12 U14 U15

1 **have** / 've U9
2 **since** U12
3 **just** / recently U7 U8
4 **ago** U12 U14
5 **had** U15
6 **haven't** U7
7 **yet** U7
8 **has** U9 U10
9 **for** U12
10 **ever** U8
11 **Have** U7 U8

'Did you had. . .' is impossible, so only Have fits.

12 **haven't** U8

13 Sherlock mode

U9 U10 U16

1 He's been fixing / repairing his bike. U9
2 He's been shouting (callouts) all night. U9
3 Someone has been soldering (and has burnt something). U9 U10
4 I've been studying (or gaming!) all night. U9
5 Someone has eaten all the stroopwafels! (finished result → simple) U10
6 It's been raining (hard) / He's been walking in the rain. U9
7 He's been grinding ranked / playing a lot of ranked. U9
8 She'd been doing yoga / working out. U16
9 They'd been drawing (cartoons of) him on the whiteboard. U16

Other verbs are fine if the logic works (e.g. card 2: He's been yelling; card 4: You've been revising). The key point is the form: have/has been -ing (cards 1–4, 6–7), have/has + past participle for a finished result (card 5), had been -ing for the past cards (8–9).

14 Same meaning, new shape

U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

1 **have been studying** U11 U12
2 **haven't visited my grandparents since** U11 U12
3 **the best fries** U8
4 **I've used** U8
5 **have known Arne** U11
6 **haven't been to the cinema for** U12
7 **How long have you been** U12
8 **has gone to** U7
9 **had already started** U15
10 **Have you got** U17
11 **lived in São Paulo for** U14

Trap: 2015–2022 is a finished period, so it's past simple — not have lived.

12 **has been playing for** U9 U12

15 The 3-second rule

U3 U4 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U15 U16 U17

1 I've lived / I've been living in Leuven for three years. U11

há/faz + present in Portuguese → present perfect + for in English.

2 I haven't played with you guys for ages! / It's been ages since I played with you! U11 U12

3 I've just woken up — give me five minutes. U7

acabar de = have just (AmE also: I just woke up).

4 Have you ever been to Bruges? U8

já (experience) = ever; foi a = been to.

5 How long have you been playing support? U11 U12

Not 'Since when do you play. . . ?'

6 When I arrived, the lecture/class had already started. U15

7 I was playing when the internet went down. U6

8 It's the first time I've eaten / had waterzooi. U8

Not 'the first time I eat'.

9 He's always leaving the dishes in the sink. U3

viver + -ndo (annoying habit) = always + continuous.

10 I've got a headache. / I have a headache. U17

estar com (illness) = have (got).

11 I've known her since first year. U11

12 We'd been waiting for twenty minutes when the bus finally came. U16

13 What do you think of the course? / How are you finding the course? U4

Opinion → think (simple). 'How are you finding. . . ?' is a natural alternative.

14 It's been raining since yesterday. U9 U12

Not 'It's raining since yesterday'.

16 Rapid fire

U1 U2 U3 U6 U8 U9 U11 U12 U13 U15 U17

There's no single right answer — these are models to compare with yours. Did your first verb have the right tense? Did you keep it when you added details?

1 *At the moment I'm working on our Engineering Experience project — we're building a robot. I'm also writing a lab report.* U1

2 *I usually go for a run after class, and in the evening I play a few games with friends on Discord.* U2

3 *I've been reading out loud, watching series without subtitles and talking to classmates as much as I can.* U9

4 *Yes, I have — once, before a physics exam. I studied until five, slept for two hours and almost missed the bus.* U8 U13

5 *This time last year I was still living in Brazil and studying for my exams there.* U6

6 *The best match I've ever played was a comeback in overtime: we were losing, but we won the last three fights.* U8 U13

7 *I've known my oldest friend since primary school. We met because the teacher made us sit together.* U11 U12

8 *Before I moved to Belgium, I'd never cycled in the rain every day — or eaten fries with mayonnaise!* U15

9 *My teammate is always forgetting to unmute himself, so we spend half the match shouting 'You're muted!'* U3

10 *I've got my laptop, a charger, two notebooks and a half-eaten sandwich.* U17

17 One story, three speeds

U5 U6 U8 U13 U15 U16

A model for story C (about 2 minutes at a relaxed pace). The target forms are in bold.

It **was** a Tuesday afternoon, and we **were doing** our first electronics lab. Everybody **was rushing** because the session ended at five. I**'d never used** that kind of power supply before, and I**'d been staring** at the circuit diagram for twenty minutes without really understanding it. My lab partner **connected** the last capacitor, and I **switched** on the power. Suddenly there **was** a loud pop and a lot of smoke. We**'d connected** the capacitor the wrong way round! The TA **ran** over, **switched** everything off and **looked** at us in silence. It **was** the first time I**'d** ever **burnt** a component. Since then, I**'ve checked** every circuit twice before switching it on — and I **haven't burnt** anything else. Yet.

18 Shadow & rebuild

U1 U2 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U15 U16

No key needed — but check your rebuilt version for these: I've been back… for *(not* I'm back since*)* · I'd been using *(before another past moment)* · I was ordering… and I froze *(background + event)* · I'd forgotten · I've already had *(this week isn't over)*. *Vault:* dust something off = *start using a skill again after a long time.*

UNIT TAGS

U1 Present continuous
U2 Present simple
U3 Present cont. vs simple 1
U4 Present cont. vs simple 2
U5 Past simple
U6 Past continuous
U7 Present perfect 1
U8 Present perfect 2
U9 Present perfect continuous
U10 Pres. perf. cont. vs simple
U11 How long have you (been)…?
U12 for / since; when…? / how long…?
U13 Present perfect vs past 1
U14 Present perfect vs past 2
U15 Past perfect
U16 Past perfect continuous
U17 have and have got